

Top Power BI Interview Questions with Answers

1 What is a dashboard vs a report?

- **Report:** A multi-page, detailed view of your data with multiple visuals per page. Built in Power BI Desktop.
- **Dashboard:** A single-page summary of visuals pinned from reports. Created in Power BI Service.

2 How do you publish a report to the Power BI Service?

- Click Publish in Power BI Desktop → Sign in → Select your workspace.
- The report uploads to Power BI Service for sharing, scheduling, and dashboard creation.

3 Explain row-level security in Power BI?

- Limits data visibility for users based on roles.
- You define roles with DAX filters (e.g., Region = "West") in Desktop, then assign users to roles in Service.

4 What is Power BI Gateway?

- A bridge between on-premises data and the Power BI Service.

Two types:

- Personal Gateway (for individual use)
- Standard Gateway (for team/shared use)

5 What is a bookmark?

- Saves the current state of a report page (filters, visuals, selections).
- Useful for navigation, storytelling, or toggling views.

6 How do you schedule data refresh in Power BI?

- In Power BI Service:
- Go to the dataset → Schedule refresh
- Set frequency, time, and configure credentials if needed (Gateway required for on-prem data).

7 What are visuals in Power BI?

- Graphical representations of data (bar charts, line graphs, maps, cards, etc.).
- Custom visuals can also be imported for advanced scenarios.

8 How can you import data into Power BI?

- **Use Get Data → choose sources: Excel, SQL Server, Web, APIs, etc.**
- **Data is then transformed via Power Query and loaded into the model.**

9 What is the difference between DirectQuery and Import mode?

- **Import: Data is cached into Power BI → Faster but requires refreshes.**
- **DirectQuery: Queries data live from the source → Slower, but always current.**

10 What is drillthrough and drilldown?

- **Drillthrough: Navigate to a new page filtered by selected value (e.g., click a region → open region detail page).**
- **Drilldown: Explore data hierarchy within the same visual (e.g., year → quarter → month).**